

3.5 Making Decisions

if / else

Lets the program follow a different path depending on a condition.

```
if (age >= 18) {  
    std::println("You are an adult.");  
} else {  
    std::println("You are a minor.");  
}
```

Comparisons between two variables

Comparisons aren't just for one variable against a fixed number - they work between two variables too.

```
if (age == friendAge) {  
    std::println("{} and {} are the same age.", name, friendName);  
} else if (age < friendAge) {  
    std::println("{} is younger than {}.", name, friendName);  
} else {  
    std::println("{} is older than {}.", name, friendName);  
}
```

The comparison operators used here

Operator	Meaning
<code>==</code>	equal to
<code><</code>	less than
<code>>=</code>	greater than or equal to

Same operators, applied where they're actually useful - not memorized as an isolated list.

A gotcha: leftover newline

```
std::cin >> age;  
std::cin.ignore(); // discard the leftover newline  
  
std::getline(std::cin, friendName); // otherwise this reads an empty line
```

`std::cin >>` leaves the `\n` you pressed sitting in the input buffer.

Next: 3.6

Doing It Many Times